

the entries as extra practice in reading about research studies in psychology in the popular media. Follow me on X to get the latest blog updates (@bmorling); I usually post twice a month.

Changes in the Fifth Edition

Instructors who have used earlier editions will be happy to learn that the organization remains the same. I have replaced some chapter examples (see the table), meaning that instructors who assign the Fifth Edition can still use their favorite illustrations from past editions as extra examples while teaching. I also revised and refined several content areas for this edition.

First, as an ethical and scientific imperative, this edition strives to present more content around issues of inclusion and belonging. The revisions reflect a variety of critical perspectives from recent years. One part of the story, of course, is that psychology needs to use more diverse samples. But many (including the American Psychological Association) have argued that psychology also needs to acknowledge how the field has used science to promote racism. It needs to address historical and structural racism and find ways to ensure that its scientists, scholars, and journal editors reflect the true diversity of people in our communities. A truly inclusive psychological science should also embrace methodological pluralism, including more respect for qualitative research.

With these values and perspectives in mind, I've made a variety of revisions. For one, I added some new content on qualitative research (see **Chapters 1** and **6**). I replaced some chapter examples with studies that emphasize inclusion. For example, one study tested ways to promote pro-diversity norms on campus (**Chapter 10**). Another study trained teachers with an empathy mindset in discipline situations, an intervention that benefited all students, but especially students of color. I also revised **Chapter 14** to add some discussion of racism in psychology and added more emphasis on the value of external validity. Research suggests that, for many students, exposure to such critical histories can signal belonging and identity safety, improving their academic motivation (for an excellent review, see Salter et al., 2024).

Chapter 4 (Ethical Guidelines for Psychology Research) is also significantly revised. I updated the human subjects discussion; it now gives equal weight to the American and Canadian ethics codes. (Many Canadian university students use this book, and I wanted to support them.) In response to thoughtful reviewer comments, I also completely revised the animal ethics section of **Chapter 4**; it now better reflects contemporary thinking on the use of nonhuman animals in research.

The Fifth Edition continues to reflect the new methodological standards developed after psychology's replication crisis. In this edition, I've revised several illustrative scatterplots; formerly these were cartoons with 20 or 30 points. Now they include hundreds of points, to help students get used to studies with larger sample sizes (something our field is now prioritizing). I continue to refine the language around effect size to stay current with how people are currently describing "small" versus "large" effects in psychology.

As in the Fourth Edition, I continue to present the estimation approach (the “new statistics”) instead of foregrounding the *p* values and statistical significance of null hypothesis significance testing (NHST). Psychological statisticians have argued for years in favor of this shift (e.g., Cumming, 2014) and many instructors know they *should* start to teach it—but there are few undergraduate models out there. In this book, my hope is to empower instructors by modeling how to teach the new statistics to students. Trust me: You can do it! In fact, students are more likely to grasp estimation and precision than they are to correctly define statistical significance. Instructors new to the approach should start by reading **Chapter S2**, including Table S2.3. And rest assured: The book still explains statistical significance and NHST: In fact, the Fifth Edition provides even more NHST support. But instead of leading with it, I foreground effect size and 95% confidence intervals and explain that a statistically significant result is obtained when the confidence interval doesn’t contain zero. I continue to be grateful to Dr. Robert Calin-Jageman for helping me present this approach accurately.

Every college instructor knows that artificial intelligence, or AI, started changing our teaching lives in the fall of 2022. I have updated the third supplemental chapter, Presenting Results, with coverage of these tools. I’m grateful to librarian Maria Barefoot and educational technology specialist Lauren Kelley at the University of Delaware for helping me write about these tools.

To make room for some of the newer content in the fifth edition, we decided to move the Working It Through sections that once appeared in several chapters (**Chapters 3, 4, 5, 8, and 11**) to the Norton Teaching Tools. Each works though a single study in depth so students can observe how the chapter’s central concepts are integrated and applied.

Here is a detailed list of the changes made to each chapter.

Chapter	Major Changes in the Fifth Edition
1. Psychology Is a Way of Thinking	A new figure shows students how to apply the theory-data cycle to two specific examples. New key terms, <i>qualitative research</i> and <i>quantitative research</i>, are introduced. I removed the discussion of translational research and its accompanying figure.

Chapter	Major Changes in the Fifth Edition
2. Sources of Information: Why Research Is Best and How to Find It	My own students often share the latest “psychology news” from TikTok. At their suggestion, I included a new example: the claim that tapping on your face can control feelings of anxiety. I’ve gotten so many comments from faculty over the years about whether the “present/present” bias is truly its own concept. I ultimately agreed with them, so I removed the present/present bias as a key term. That leaves the availability heuristic, the confirmation bias, and the bias blind spot as the main topics in this section. I also added a terrific study showing confirmation bias related to genetic testing and depression after reading Woo-kyoung Ahn’s (2022) book, <i>Thinking 101</i>.
3. Three Claims, Four Validities: Interrogation Tools for Consumers of Research	The three claims, four validities framework is the same, keeping the best teachable examples from the previous edition and adding new examples from recent media.
4. Ethical Guidelines for Psychology Research	I have revised the first major section to give equal weight to American and Canadian ethics codes for research with humans. I have also significantly revised the animal ethics section to reflect contemporary perspectives.
5. Identifying Good Measurement	Two minor revisions here: I replaced the head circumference example with one on height and extroversion. I also streamlined the organization of the section on reliability. Previously, the three forms of reliability were introduced, then explained in more depth. I’ve consolidated the organization.

Chapter	Major Changes in the Fifth Edition
6. Surveys and Observations: Describing What People Do	I value exposing students to qualitative research as a viable alternative to quantitative methods, so there's a new section at the end introducing two types of qualitative research: interviews and focus groups. However, I also realize that my brief coverage cannot capture the full depth and sophistication of these methods. For a slightly richer overview, consider assigning Cope (2014).
7. Sampling: Estimating the Frequency of Behaviors and Beliefs	This chapter is largely the same, but I've added a new example that compares three different "big data" estimates of American COVID-19 vaccination rates. The example illustrates that larger samples do not necessarily provide more accurate estimates.
8. Bivariate Correlational Research	I removed the previous edition's example on brain thickness and time spent sitting because the sample in the study was simply too small by today's standards. I replaced it with a new study on the negative correlation between greed and well-being. I made some small revisions to the effect size discussion here. I added a new example of a moderator (the negative relationship between social media use and well-being is stronger for girls than for boys).
9. Multivariate Correlational Research	The structure and core examples have stayed the same.

Chapter	Major Changes in the Fifth Edition
10. Introduction to Simple Experiments	This chapter retains the Fourth Edition example on baby persistence, but I added a new featured example on diversity norms messaging (Murrar et al, 2020). The norms study replaces the previous example, on laptop versus longhand notetaking, in light of recent failures to replicate this effect.
11. More on Experiments: Confounding and Obscuring Variables	No major revisions to this chapter.
12. Experiments with More Than One Independent Variable	This chapter’s organization and teaching strategy remain the same; however, I’ve replaced the core examples with new ones. You’ll see a study on empathy mindset interventions for teachers, as well as a classic study on the value of retrieval practice. The “Batman” study from <u>Chapter 3</u> also plays a supporting role.
13. Quasi-Experiments and Small-N Designs	There are two excellent new examples of quasi-experiments here. One documents the impact of pharmaceutical marketing strategies on the opioid crisis in the United States. The other shows that Logic’s suicide hotline song, 1-800, reduced suicides in the United States.

Chapter	Major Changes in the Fifth Edition
14. Replication, Credibility, and Wider Importance	This chapter has a new title and has been updated to reflect the current state of the field. I updated the replication section based on Nosek et al.'s (2022) comprehensive review. I have also reorganized the section on generalization, external validity, and ecological validity. There's less focus on theory-testing versus generalization mode and a bit more critique of psychology's traditional focus on internal validity (over external validity). This section includes some new content on psychology's racist history (but also mentions those who opposed scientific racism). It also addresses representation and inclusion among editors and other scientific gatekeepers.
Supplementary Chapters	Chapter S1, on descriptive statistics, has not changed much. Chapter S2, on inferential statistics, is very similar to the Fourth Edition but provides more support for instructors who still wish to teach NHST. In Chapter S3, you'll find a new box addressing the ethics, benefits, and practical concerns of using AI tools in scientific writing. I have also added several suggestions for responsible ways to use AI tools in scientific writing.